INTRODUCTION

Development has been a central theme of discussion in social science discourses for a long time but what is noteworthy is the expansion of the meaning of the term development. The economic disparity between the rich and the poor countries, the obstacles faced by the poor developing countries in the path of their development and the causes behind their underdevelopment have created immense enthusiasm among the scholars belonging to the different genres to probe into the questions of development. Whether development should be, strictly speaking, seen to be something related to economic growth or it is something beyond that has created myriad perspectives on development. There are the liberal and alternative views on development accompanied by the Marxian concept on what constitutes underdevelopment. There is also now the current definition of development provided by the United Nations, Development Programme (UNDP) along with the Human Development Index (HDI), 1990. The United Nations Conference on Environment and Development (UNCED) and also referred to as the Rio Summit or the Earth Summit), 1992 gave a new direction to the concept of development which upheld 27 principles intended to guide the future sustainable development around the world.